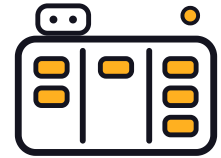


THE TASK BOARD LESSON • LESSON 5 OF 6

Robots Do the Boring Work



A 45-minute AI-and-future-jobs lesson: your class runs a busy recording studio, decides which tasks go to AI, which get AI's help, and which stay human — and owns the tradeoff behind each choice. Stands alone.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Studio Task Board worksheet (2 pages, 1 per student; fillable PDF copy included) · Slides (optional; script and keys in the notes) · board + marker for the three columns · Defense Rubric (Teacher Guide p.3) · pens	None — fully unplugged. Optional: a projector for the slides	Print worksheets. That's it.

OBJECTIVES & STANDARDS

- Sort real job tasks into **automate** / **augment** / **keep human** and explain the difference. (*Sort the Board; Exit Ticket*)
- Compare the tradeoffs of an automation choice — who wins, who loses something, what could go wrong. (*Trade Cards; Exit Ticket AUTOMATE line*)
- Defend a sorting decision aloud: a clear claim, a specific detail, eyes up, voice to the back. (*Defend It — listener strip + Defense Rubric*)

CSTA 2-IC-20

CCSS ELA SL.6.4

ISTE 1.3.d

WARM-UP — THE MOST BORING JOB EVER (7 MIN)

Ask: "What's the most boring job you can think of?" Board 4–5 answers, then push on two or three of them:

"Is it boring because it REPEATS — same thing, over and over, no decisions? Or is it 'boring' but secretly full of people stuff — helping, noticing, calming someone down?" Sort them as a class: repeats → give it to a robot; people stuff → keep it human. (A cafeteria cashier's job repeats — but the cashier also knows which kid forgot lunch money. Let them argue; the arguing is the point.)

Bridge: "Here's the honest version, no robot apocalypse: nobody can promise which jobs change, or how many. So far, it's the boring, repeating parts that get automated — AI takes over tasks, not whole jobs, and nobody can promise the final count. But every time a business automates something, somebody wins, somebody loses something, and something could go wrong. Today YOU make those decisions — for a recording studio."

What if nobody names a people-stuff job? Offer one: "Bus driver — repeats the route, but notices who's crying in row six."

Transition: "So how do you decide what a robot should take? Three columns. Eyes on the board."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION — THREE COLUMNS, ONE QUESTION (10 MIN)

Draw three columns on the board (slide 4 if projecting) and define them. Say it out loud once: a "call" is a decision.

AUTOMATE — boring and repeating. No decisions to make. Hand it to AI.

AUGMENT — a human makes the call, AI helps out.

KEEP HUMAN — coaching, taste, being there for someone. The person is the whole point.

Watch one get sorted (Direct Instruction, continued) — model the tradeoff lens ("the trade") on one task. "Send the 'don't forget your session' texts." Column: AUTOMATE — but don't stop there:

WHO WINS?	WHO LOSES SOMETHING?	WHAT COULD GO WRONG?
Jaylen — gets hours of his week back.	Jaylen, a little — sending those texts is how he learned every artist's name.	A cheerful reminder lands after a canceled session.

Say it plainly: "The column is the easy part. The trade is the real thinking. In this room, 'because robots' is not a reason. 'Who wins, who loses something, what could go wrong' — that's a reason."

What if someone says "automate everything, it's all boring"? "Automate E — the nervous singer gets a chatbot coach. Who lost something?"

Hand-out / transition: "One each, pairs of two. Page 1: meet Nia, Ravi and Jaylen; read tasks A to L. Don't sort yet."

MAIN ACTIVITY — THE STUDIO TASK BOARD (15 MIN)

- Sort (8 min):** Pairs write each letter A–L in one of the three tall columns — as many as belong; every column gets at least two. Disagreeing partners talk it out; either can be right. Keep slides 8–9 (the task list) up.

What if a pair is stuck? "Does it repeat, or is it people stuff?" Ten letters in AUTOMATE? "Which two would you hate to lose a person on?"

Transition: "Pens down. Page 2. Pick the TWO choices you argued about most — those are your trade cards."

- Trade cards (7 min):** Each pair picks TWO choices; each student writes the trade on their own sheet — who wins, who loses something, what could go wrong.

What if an answer is "nobody loses"? Even Jaylen lost something. "Who used to do this task? What did they get from it?"

Transition: "Stop there. Now you have to say it out loud — to people who might disagree."

DEFEND IT — SAY IT OUT LOUD (8 MIN)

Teach the delivery first (1 min): "Three moves: eyes up off the page, voice to the back wall, slow down on the word because." **Pairs of pairs (5 min):** two pairs face each other, one student across from each. The claim is the frame on worksheet p.2: "Task ___ belongs in ___ because ___ — and the trade is ___." Speaker 1 reads their claim out loud (30 seconds), then slides their sheet across. Listener 1 checks the three boxes and writes keep or fix (30 seconds), then slides it back. Switch: Speaker 2 reads, Listener 2 marks. Everyone ends with their own sheet. Each student's claim is scored; you sample 3–4 pairs with the Defense Rubric (Teacher Guide p.3). **Whole class (2 min):** three pairs bring their most-argued choice to the room — or post the boards and gallery-walk for 2 minutes.

What if a Speaker reads to the desk? Don't score it: "Eyes on us, one more time." The second try counts. **Odd number of pairs** → one trio of pairs rotates; sample that group. Trio: 20 seconds each, listeners mark the boxes only.

Transition: "You already have your own sheet — bottom of page 2. A job you actually know."

EXIT TICKET (5 MIN)

Worksheet p.2, bottom, solo: the three columns on **a job someone in their life really has** — AUTOMATE also names who loses something; KEEP HUMAN has a why. Collect; exemplar and scoring in the Teacher Guide, p.2.

What if a student says "I don't know anyone with a job"? "Your teacher has one. Sort mine."

DIFFERENTIATION

- Support:** Sort 8 tasks, not 12 (skip B, F, J, L — every column still gets two); the definitions and claim frame are printed on the sheet.
- Extension:** Find one task where automating saves money now but hurts the studio in a year — explain the chain.
- ELL:** Sorting letters keeps writing low; the claim frame doubles as a language frame; argue in any language, present in English.
- No-device classrooms:** Built in — the whole lesson runs on paper and talk; the slides are optional. With devices: none needed; optionally project the task board.